TCG

VOLUNTEER HANDBOOK

Volunteering with seniors in your community is a rewarding adventure that enriches the lives of residents living in our home. It is our sincere hope that you find this experience meaningful and rewarding. Our volunteers are as diverse as our residents. Students ranging from high school to university, seniors, and recently retired adults compose our volunteer community. At The Care Group, we welcome each new volunteer and we appreciate the effort and experiences you bring to this role.

How To Apply

1. Complete the application form, complete the criminal record check and provide 2 personal references.
2. We will then arrange to determine your suitability, areas of interest, and availability. After the completion of a successful interview, the criminal record check will be faxed to the ministry of justice and a TB screening interview will be completed.

Once the above requirements have been satisfied, and references checked an orientation will be scheduled to familiarize you with the home, the residents, our expectations, and protocols. At that time you will be asked to familiarize yourself with the volunteer handbook and sign a pledge of confidentiality.

The Ideal Volunteer is

- A good listener with strong English skills (other languages are an asset)
- Interested in the lives of others
- Patient and friendly
- Caring and nurturing
- Kind and compassionate

What is your passion?

- In-house Recreation Programs (e.g., Bingo, crafts, games, entertainment)
- Community Outings
- Music
- One-to-One Friendly Visits
- Sing Along

Background Information on our Homes

The Care Group provides care, services and support to elders and those people who are living with a condition that requires 24 hour nursing care.

Resident Interactions

Volunteers spend their time with the residents of our homes. We ask that you give the residents your undivided attention, energy, and knowledge during your volunteer hours. Your participation inspires the residents to join and take part in social activities. Your presence lends variety to the environment. We ask you to engage the residents, listen to them and laugh with them, perhaps set up an activity of your own and encourage residents t participation.

It is important to ask the residents' permission before initiating any activity or helping a resident in any way. If a resident wishes to participate or be assisted, they will let you know. It is always the resident's choice to participate or not in events.

Your experience will be varied, depending on how you approach the task at hand. Challenges may arise due to personalities, differences of opinion, culture, and/or education. All challenges require your patience and understanding. Some tips that you might find helpful.

1. Do not assume. Ask.
2. Do not take any interaction personally.
3. Listen without interruption.
4. Try not to react emotionally.
5. If you find yourself struggling, approach a staff/team member for assistance. We are here `

Resident Safety

Resident safety is your number one concern. Clean up any spills. Tidy anything that could be a tripping hazard. Report any other hazards to your supervisor or another staff member.

Your priority is to inspire the residents to be active, social, and engaged; to provide company, actively listen and participate with the residents.

Your energy inspires others. Your interest in another person's life story helps them to recall long-forgotten memories. It also allows the resident to share life lessons, advice, and tips with you. Our residents have lived long and interesting l ives. A little bit of history comes with every resident.

Be Respectful and Genuine

Talk to the residents openly, honestly, and as you would talk to your friends. Call the residents by their names. Avoid the words "sweetie" or "honey" when referring to the residents. Be prepared to answer the same question repeatedly with patience and understanding possibly redirecting an individual's attention to a different task to lessen the resident's anxiety.

Practical Tips

Working with Seniors

Please assist the Residents in maintaining their independence. Encourage residents to complete tasks to the best of their ability only providing your support.

C. Communicate A. Ask T. Then Help

- Approach from the front; introduce yourself and your intention clearly.
- Ask permission to be or share time with a resident.
- Listen and be respectful.
- Smile, encourage and inspire residents in all that they do.
- Allow residents to do things in their own time. Do not rush and be patient.
- Do NOT provide residents with any personal details.

For the Visually Impaired

- Ask how you can best assist them.
- Identify steps/obstacles in the path.
- Avoid glare or poorly lit areas.
- Communicate your willingness to help.

For the Hearing Impaired

- Face the person to speak.
- Lower the pitch of your voice.
- Speak clearly and at a moderate rate. Do not over-articulate.
- Watch the expressions on the listener's face and note when the words are not caught.
- If the person has one good ear, sit closer to that ear.
- If necessary, take along a notepad to use in order to help you communicate.

For the Mobility Impaired

- Move slowly and deliberately. Ask how you can assist.
- Ask how you can best assist them in getting in and out of a chair.
- Avoid sudden changes in motion or direction.
- Communicate your willingness to help.

For the Breathing Impaired

- Limit physical activity – climbing steps or walking far.
- Avoid open windows, fumes, or smoking.

For those with Dementia

- Set a positive mood for interaction.
- State your message clearly.
- Ask simple, answerable questions.
- Listen with your ears and eyes.
- Break down activities into a series of steps.
- Distract and redirect.
- Respond with reassurance.
- Maintain your sense of humor.

For those with Depression or Anxiety

- Listen.
- Don't change the subject
- Acknowledge their feelings.
- Do not judge.
- Resist giving advice.
- Praise accomplishments (even minor).
- Be patient, do not push and allow them to talk.

Maintain Confidentiality

Do not share informationwith anyone your friends. Do not gossip. Avoid gossip. Respect confidentiality and do not post names, pictures or information on Social media sites about residents or staff.

Your Safety as a Volunteer

Your safety is important to us. You will note that we include items under the dress code that are designed for your safety. In addition, the following information will keep you safe. Please ensure you receive both the flu vaccine and COVID vaccines. This keeps you, our residents, and our staff safe. Please avoid coming to work when suffering from a fever, cough, or cold.

No Lift Policy

There is a no-lift policy in place at our Homes. . If the resident cannot get up by themselves or is hurt any attempt to move them may cause further, unforeseen complications.If a resident has fallen immediately call for help from the nearest staff member and alert the The nearest Nurse on duty.

Suggestions for Appropriate Attire:

Dress is appropriately casual. Clothing should be clean and attractive. Avoid the following:

1. No overly close-fit clothing
2. No bare shoulders
3. Midriff or excessively
4. Tight lycra styled pants or tops

The following suggestions are designed with your safety in mind:

- We suggest a one-color plain cotton t-shirt and knee-length shorts or full-length or Capri style casual pants.
- Remove excessive piercings.
- Keep make-up to a minimum, nails neat, clean and short.
- Wear comfortable flat, closed-toed shoes with a good rubber sole.
- No perfume or perfumed deodorant due to allergies. If your attire is deemed to be inappropriate you will be sent home.

Name tags are to be worn at all times.

These will be issued on your first day and kept in the office.

No cell phone during volunteer hours

Our residents need our undivided attention. Please speak to the Recreation Coordinator or Director of Care if you need to have your cell phone for an urgent matter.

Do **NOT** bring valuables with you during volunteer hours. The recreation office is unlocked and open.

Do **NOT** accept Gifts (monetary or otherwise) from the residents or residents' families.